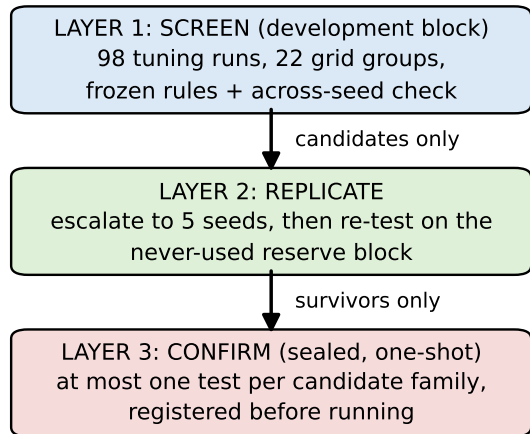
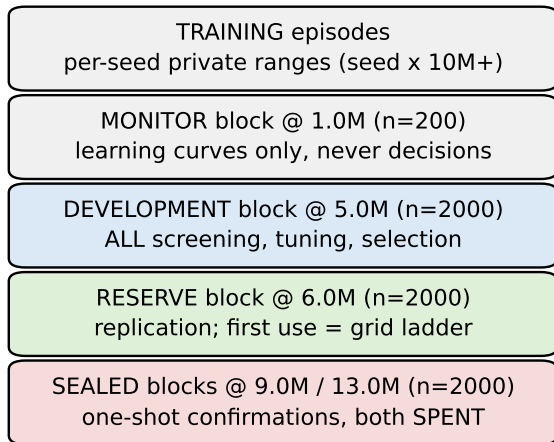


Evaluation architecture: disjoint episode blocks and the screen / replicate / confirm ladder

EPISODE-SEED BLOCKS (disjoint by construction) THE THREE-LAYER LADDER (pre-registered)



WHAT HAPPENED: 2 tuning champions passed layer 1 and went to sealed tests:
BOTH FAILED (pooled -0.002 , $p=0.38$ / $p=0.39$). 2 grid triggers passed layer 1
($p=0.014$, $p=0.0003$), survived 5-seed escalation, then BOTH DIED on the reserve
block (one sign-flipped to $+0.018$); no third sealed test was spent.
Headline: the agent does not beat TWAP out-of-sample.